

Consent Form - ICF

Dear Participant,

You are being invited to participate in a research study for data collection. We kindly request your participation in this study, which aims to evaluate models of Architecture Decision Records (ADRs). Please be informed that your participation in this research is entirely voluntary.

1) Procedures

The participant will be invited to fill out a profile characterization form and to take part in tasks that involve the analysis and documentation of architectural decisions using different ADR models. At the end, the participant will answer a feedback questionnaire about the research. Your personal data will be kept confidential throughout the entire study. The results will be anonymized and may be published in a scientific article, along with quantitative and qualitative analyses.

2) Confidentiality of the Research

The data collected during this study will be used strictly for research purposes and will not be employed in any form of professional or personal evaluation. All information collected in this study is confidential, and your name and the name of your organization will not be identified in any way, unless explicit authorization is granted for that purpose.

3) Costs and Benefits

This research aims to propose effective models and practices for the documentation of software architecture decisions. Based on the data obtained, we intend to identify the strengths of different ADR models and propose efficient solutions, thus building a knowledge base that guides developers and software architects in recording architectural decisions. All research involving human beings carries some level of risk. In this study, participants will not incur any cost or burden for their participation and will not receive any form of reimbursement or compensation for taking part.

4) Participation

You are being invited to participate due to your technical knowledge of software architecture and decision-making, whether acquired through industry experience or academic training. Your participation in this study is very important and entirely voluntary. Participants have the right not to participate or to withdraw from the study at any time without any penalty. Participants also have the right to decline to answer any of the questions in the questionnaires and/or interviews.

This document (ICF) will be prepared in two copies, which will be initialed on all pages, except for the one containing the signatures, and signed at the end by both the participant and the responsible researcher. Each party will keep one copy.

5) Statement of Consent

I have read or have had someone read to me the information contained in this document before signing this informed consent form. I declare that all technical language used to describe this research study was satisfactorily explained and that I received answers to all my questions. I also confirm that I have received a copy of this Informed Consent Form. I understand that I am free to withdraw from the study at any time, without any penalty. I declare that I am over 18 years of age and I give my consent freely and voluntarily to participate in this study.

The researchers responsible for the study are available to provide any clarification or answer questions at any time. Their contact information is as follows

Researcher	Email: XXXXXXXX@XXX.com
Supervisor	Email: XXXXXXXX@XXX.com
Co-supervisor	Email: XXXXXXXX@XXX.com

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Participant

Researcher